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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025
Third SEMESTER
Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG3DSEPSY201 - POSITIVE PSYCHOLOGY
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Part A: Multiple Choice Questions (1 mark each, 20 marks)

1. c) Validating specific techniques that repair damage and map uniquely into DSM-IV categories.
2. b) Mihaly Csikszentmihalyi.
3. b) Empathy and positive emotions.
4. b) Directly assign responsibility to specific bystanders.
5. d) Emotional.
6. a) Eudaimonic.
7. d) Subjective well-being.
8. a) Eudaimonia.
9. c) Noticing the situation.
10. c) Identify their strengths, cultivate self-compassion, and develop a more fulfilling life.
11. c) Resilience.
12. a) EI application.
13. a) Savouring.
14. b) Beliefs about one’s ability to succeed.
15. b) Peer acceptance.
16. c) Anterior Cingulate Cortex (ACC) and Anterior Insula.
17. b) Mental health is psychological functioning, while well-being is overall life quality.
18. b) Bounce back quickly from stress and adversity.
19. a) It helps bounce back from challenges.
20. b) If they become a rote exercise or a chore.

Part B: Short Answer Questions (3 marks each, answer any 10, 30 marks)

21. Positive prevention: a method of building an individual's strengths and positive qualities, such as optimism and resilience, to act as a buffer against mental illness and to enhance overall well-being. Strategies include identifying and fostering innate strengths, creating buffer, Proactive and reactive, evidence based techniques, promoting and flourishing.
22. Meaningful life: A life in which an individual finds purpose, coherence, and significance beyond mere happiness, often linked to eudaimonia, achieved by using signature strengths and virtues in the service of something much larger than the person himself. It involves aligning one’s actions with values, nurturing relationships, and contributing to something beyond self, which promotes overall well-being and a sense of lasting satisfaction.
23. Positive Feedback Loop for low self-efficacy in maths: Encourage small achievable goals, provide positive reinforcement, monitor progress, and adjust efforts to boost self-regulation and esteem.
24. Why is forgiveness considered a crucial concept for society?: It promotes social harmony, reduces interpersonal and group conflicts, and fosters emotional healing and reconciliation. It facilitates social cohesion, and breaks destructive cycles of hurt and retaliation. It provides a foundation for justice and peace, allowing individuals and communities to heal and move forward after trauma
25. Explain how setting goals can contribute to happines: Achieving meaningful goals enhances life satisfaction by providing purpose and motivation. Goals give life structure and a sense of "what's next," combating feelings of aimlessness. Fosters Engagement and Flow, Boosts Self-Efficacy and Competence, Creates Positive Emotions, Connects to Values and Meaning and Goals can help structure daily activities and routines in a way that is productive and fulfilling.

26. Define Human Flourishing and explain how it broadens the scope beyond simple happiness: Human flourishing is defined as a state of living "within an optimal range of human functioning" that encompasses a holistic sense of well-being and fulfillment across multiple dimensions of life, not merely simple happiness. It is an active, ongoing process of developing one's capabilities, strengths, and virtues, it includes optimal functioning in life domains such as meaning, relationships, and personal growth. PERMA model explains this. PERMA stands for Positive emotions, Engagement, Relationships, Meaning, and Accomplishment, and these elements are crucial for a fulfilling and flourishing life
27. Characteristics of hedonic happiness: Focus on pleasure attainment and pain avoidance, immediate gratification, and positive affect. Key characteristics include a focus on immediate gratification from sensory pleasures (like good food), external validation (like fame or money), and short-lived bursts of fun rather than long-lasting fulfillment.
28. Benefits of flow for young adults: Enhanced engagement and intrinsic motivation, improved skill development and well-being in addition to increased happiness, creativity, and motivation, along with better emotional regulation and improved performance and productivity. Flow helps build confidence and resilience, and provides a sense of purpose and accomplishment, which contributes to overall psychological well-being and personal development, lack of self efficacy.
29. Decision model of helping (fainting in crowded place): Steps - noticing, interpreting emergency, assuming responsibility, Knowing how to help, deciding to help, implementing help; obstacles – Bystander effect, diffusion of responsibility, fear, ambiguity, personal distress.
30. Ryff's model vs Diener's SWB model: Ryff emphasizes psychological well-being with multiple dimensions; Diener focuses on subjective well-being emphasizing affect and life satisfaction. Diener's model defines well-being from a subjective, "hedonic" perspective focused on happiness and pleasure, It leaves the definition of a good life up to the individual's own subjective judgment. Focus is maximizing pleasure and happiness while minimizing pain and negative emotions. It is about "feeling good. Components- Life Satisfaction, Positive Affect and Negative Affect. while Ryff's model defines it from an "eudaimonic" perspective focused on objective psychological functioning and self-realization. It is rooted in developmental and humanistic psychology and focuses on the realization of human potential. Optimal psychological functioning and personal growth. It suggests there are objective, universal criteria for a good life. t has six distinct dimensions: Autonomy, Environmental Mastery, Personal Growth, Positive Relations with Others, Purpose in Life and Self-Acceptance.
31. Self-concept vs self-esteem: Self-concept is the cognitive understanding of oneself; self-esteem is the evaluative and emotional appraisal of self-worth. Self-concept is a collection of beliefs about One's self, whereas self-esteem is the feeling of self-worth and value derived from those beliefs.
32. According to goal theory, when does life satisfaction increase?- Life satisfaction increases when goals are aligned with personal values and are attainable. Life satisfaction increases when individuals perceive a smaller gap between their actual and desired states. This occurs when goals are achieved, especially intrinsic ones related to personal growth and meaning, and when people feel a sense of progress and accomplishment
33. Explain how emotional storytelling can strengthen relationships: Sharing personal stories evokes empathy, trust, and emotional bonds strengthening relationships. By fostering empathy and trust through shared vulnerability, clarifying misunderstandings, and creating a deeper sense of connection and shared experience, It allows individuals to share their inner emotional world, bridging gaps in understanding and making partners feel seen and heard.

Part C: Essay Questions (10 marks each, answer any 2, 20 marks)

34. Positive psychology definition, dimensions, and scope:

Definition: It is the scientific study of human flourishing and optimal functioning, focusing on what makes life worth living by cultivating strengths and well-being, rather than solely on mental illness.

Dimensions: 1. The Pleasant Life (maximizing positive emotions and sensory pleasures), 2. the Good Life (achieving flow and deep engagement by utilizing one's signature strengths in activities), and 3. The Meaningful Life (finding purpose by contributing to something larger than oneself, such as values or serving others).

Or

1.Subjective Level, it investigates internal, positive states like happiness, joy, life satisfaction, and positive emotions (e.g., love, contentment), as well as constructive thoughts such as optimism and hope. 2. The Individual Level focuses on stable, positive individual traits and enduring behavior patterns, encompassing character strengths or virtues like courage, honesty, persistence, and wisdom, alongside the pursuit of excellence and creative potential. 3. Finally, the Society/Group Level examines the development and maintenance of positive institutions, addressing issues critical to collective flourishing, such as civic virtues, creating healthy families, and fostering positive communities and work environments.

The scope of positive psychology is vast, applying its principles and research to promote well-being and flourishing across three main levels: the Individual Level (e.g., personal growth, resilience, relationships), the Group and Organizational Level (e.g., positive organizations, education, family systems), and the Community and Societal Level (e.g., informing public policy, building positive communities, and integrating into therapy).Scope: Application in education, therapy, workplace, and community well-being.

35. Grateful reappraisal for coping with painful memory:

Grateful reappraisal is a cognitive restructuring technique that transforms the meaning of a negative event. It shifts the focus from the suffering caused by the memory to the subsequent benefits or strengths gained.Using gratitude to reinterpret past negative experiences positively, focusing on lessons learned and personal growth, thereby reducing distress.

- Acknowledge the Pain, Then Shift Focus: The process doesn't involve minimizing the original hurt or trauma. Instead, the individual first acknowledges the pain associated with the memory, but then deliberately directs their thoughts to what good has since emerged.
- Identify Benefits and Lessons: The person systematically asks questions regarding the lessons learned, how can the person become stronger, development of new relationship, career path or new belief, preventive measures, and the outcomes of it to re-examine the event's lasting impact.
- By finding these positive results (e.g., increased empathy, greater resilience, a deeper appreciation for current peace, finding one's life purpose), the individual is essentially reframing the painful memory not as a purely destructive force, but as a catalyst for positive change and growth.
- Cultivate Gratitude: The final step is actively feeling gratitude for those new strengths or positive consequences. This changes the emotional valence of the memory—while the memory remains painful, the overall emotional experience linked to it is now tempered with thankfulness for the resulting wisdom or benefit. Can include an example also

36. Life Enhancement Strategies in various settings: These strategies for boosting well-being and happiness draw heavily from the PERMA Model (Positive Emotion, Engagement, Relationships, Meaning, Accomplishment) and encompass actionable techniques across seven key areas. Individuals can cultivate Positive Emotions through practices like gratitude journaling, savouring positive experiences, and mindfulness meditation. Engagement (Flow) is increased by identifying and deliberately using signature strengths in daily life and pursuing optimal challenges that match skill with difficulty. Positive Relationships are nurtured by using Active-Constructive Responding to good news, performing acts of kindness, and prioritizing quality time with loved ones. Finding Meaning and Purpose involves clarifying core values, aligning actions with those values, and contributing to something larger than oneself. Accomplishment is boosted by setting SMART goals, celebrating small wins, and maintaining a growth mindset. Additionally, maintaining Physical Well-being through regular exercise, a healthy diet, and sufficient sleep is crucial. Finally, effective Cognitive Strategies include fostering optimism, using positive reappraisal to constructively reframe events, and practicing self-compassion in the face of setbacks.

The practical application of positive psychology strategies is wide-ranging, addressing well-being and flourishing across various sectors. For Individual Self-Improvement, these tools, such as mindfulness and gratitude, are used daily for stress management, personal development, and increasing resilience against adversity. In Clinical and Counselling Settings, methods are integrated into Positive Psychotherapy and coaching to not only alleviate distress but also actively build client strengths. Education (Positive Education) implements programs to teach students and train teachers in practices like gratitude and character strengths to foster student flourishing and academic success. Workplaces (Positive Organizations) utilize these strategies to boost employee well-being, engagement, and

productivity through initiatives like strengths-based leadership and connecting work to a broader purpose. At the level of Family and Relationships, interventions strengthen bonds through practices like active-constructive responding and positive parenting. Finally, on a broader scale, Public Health and Policy is increasingly incorporating well-being indicators to inform policy decisions and design community interventions that promote social connection and mental health.

37. Broaden-and-Build Theory and applications:

- Theory: Positive emotions broaden awareness and build enduring personal resources. The Broaden-and-Build Model of Positive Emotions, proposed by Barbara Fredrickson, explains how positive emotions fundamentally contribute to personal growth and long-term well-being. It posits two key hypotheses that distinguish positive emotions (like joy, interest, and serenity) from negative ones (which narrow focus for survival). The Broaden Hypothesis states that positive emotions temporarily expand ("broaden") our momentary thought-action repertoires, making us more creative, flexible, and open to new ideas and experiences. The subsequent Build Hypothesis asserts that this broadened mindset allows individuals to actively accumulate ("build") enduring personal resources over time, including physical (e.g., coordination), intellectual (e.g., knowledge), social (e.g., relationships), and psychological (e.g., resilience) assets. This process creates an "upward spiral," where positive emotions lead to the building of resources, which in turn enhances well-being, making future positive emotions more likely.

Applications: Enhancing creativity and resilience in education, improving employee well-being and productivity in workplaces, and supporting therapeutic change. Challenges the "Hedonic Treadmill": Provides a scientific explanation for why positive emotions are more than just momentary pleasures; they are crucial for growth. Basis for Positive Interventions: Many positive psychology interventions (e.g., gratitude practices, mindfulness, savouring, cultivating kindness) are designed to evoke positive emotions precisely because of their broadening and building effects. Resilience: Explains how positive emotions (even in difficult times) can help individuals bounce back from adversity by building adaptive coping mechanisms. Organizational and Educational Settings: Encourages fostering positive emotions to enhance creativity, teamwork, learning, and employee engagement.